

Lit./Mythology





About the Course

Student get a glimpse of the world beyond English with a poetic biography and then focus on stories and myths created and collected in the 19th century, including Russian fairy tales, short stories from a variety of authors, and Dickens' famous text, A Christmas Carol.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grades 7-8



Placement & Combining Tips

Several readings are shared with Grades 5-6, though lesson plans include more advanced work for older students.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-8	Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 1 time/week 30 min	The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist A Christmas Carol The Man Who Invented Christmas directed Short stories and other writings

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grades 7-8				
General Lit: Grades 7-8				Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8

☐ Term 1: Print off the Iliad Selections PDF (see Quick Links).



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8



The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist



A Christmas Carol



The Man Who Invented Christmas directed

Short stories and other writings



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Extra Helpings](#)

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance, especially for Shakespeare lessons. It is helpful to read the play or a preview of it beforehand.
- Choose which books to have students read independently. See Planning and Prep notes for recommendations.



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember and/or predict what might come next. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If students have difficulty recalling, try showing an illustration, sharing something that you remember, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading and/or using a combination of visual and audio support this time) or repeating the last lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage aloud or have students read independently. For Shakespeare, it is highly recommended that each student have their own copy of the play and that you read it aloud together or read along and underline/make notes while listening to the audio recording.
- Use supportive strategies and educational tools to reduce frustration and better engage the mind, as appropriate. These could include, but are not limited to, the use of eBooks, pictures, audio, read-aloud, buddy reading, colored reading strips, etc.
- Some students may benefit from having a notebook or piece of scrap paper available to externalize ideas by drawing, recording names, or making symbolic 'squiggle' notes.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Keep an eye out for things to add to your Book of Centuries, Citizenship Notebook, and Copywork book.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or in writing. If writing, encourage students to use the full remaining lesson time and include as much detail as they can remember. For Shakespeare or

challenging books, it may be helpful to narrate more frequently and/or use props.

- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, legos, dolls, etc. to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Students who used paper or a notebook to externalize may refer to these for support. Other students who need external support may benefit from looking at a map or picture from the book while narrating.
- Students who tend to use the same type of narration all the time, can be encouraged to try another form of narration by first doing it together through play or discussion.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill that requires the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today; notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they tell about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note or take a break for the day, if necessary.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you can ask an open-ended question or use an included discussion question.

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Term 1

WEEK 1 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 1

Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ INTRO

Today we will begin a novel in verse about the Cuban-Spanish Romantic poet Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda (1814-1873) who used her writing to speak out against injustice of all kinds. If you have not read her biography already, it is linked below.

∞ Article Link: Biography of Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

1. p.169-174 "Historical Note"
2. p.ix "Historical Background"
3. p.3-10 "Books are door-shaped" - "like oxen or mules."

- Who are the people? Make a character list. Each week as you read, think about the different perspectives of the poems and how each one sees the same situation very differently. Share your observations in your narrations.

- How do the alternating viewpoints allow the poems to speak to each other? Look for poems that discuss the same topic but from different perspectives.

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Link: What Are Free Verse Poems

WEEK 2 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 2

Lightning Dreamer, cont.

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What were your first impressions of these poems?

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

p.11-24 "I feel like a new person" - "dark or light."

- How are the nuns able to support Tula?
- How did Tula's father influence her, and how has his death shaped who she is at thirteen?
- Why does Tula feel she is not so different from the slave girls she views from the barred window?
- Continue to add to your character list.

• COMPOSITION

What role do books and reading have on the story so far? How are the "rules" different for Tula? Caridad? The nuns?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Link: José María Heredia biography

WEEK 3 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 3

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

How would you describe this book (so far) to someone who had never read it?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.25-35

- How do the decisions Tula's mother made differ from what she expects from Tula? What is your impression of her mother so far?
- Why does Tula feel she can free herself "only with words"?
- Why is Tula not allowed to read books? What are her mother and stepfather afraid of happening if she reads books?

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Term 1

WEEK 4 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 4

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What did we learn about Tula's situation in the last chapter? What does her future hold?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.39-55

- What have we learned about Caridad and why she might not want to share stories of her childhood?
- What need does the orphan theater fill for Tula? Why does she have to change the stories her plays tell?

WEEK 5 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 5

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the orphan theater?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.56-70

- What was Manuel's concern in this chapter? Is it for Tula? Or himself?
- How does reading about injustice differ from actually experiencing it for Tula?

WEEK 6 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 6

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What injustice does Tula experience in the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.73-90

- Has your impression of Tula's mother changed at all throughout the story?
- Do Manuel's actions change your perception of him? How has he supported Tula throughout the story?

• COMPOSITION

Compare the concerns of Tula, Manuel, Caridad, Mama, and the Nuns in pages 73-83. Are they justified or not given the time and setting?

★ TEACHER NOTE

The tertulias brought people together in quiet defiance. They were often political rebellion disguised as parties; a way of sharing counterculture ideas in places where fascist regimes had made it dangerous, even illegal, to gather.

WEEK 7 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 7

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What risks were Tula and Manuel taking in the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.90-109

- How does Tula learn to hide her messages?
- What are some of the acts of defiance and courage in the book so far and what are their consequences?
- Why does Mama imagine their lives will be peaceful and prosperous once Tula is married? Do you think she's right?

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Term 1

WEEK 8 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 8

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.113-127

- Why can't Tula write even though she now has a degree of freedom with her Uncle gone?
- Why does Tula leave the plantation even though she's now left alone there?

WEEK 9 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 9

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What was plantation life like for Tula with her Uncle gone?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.128-144

- What happens when some of Tula's fantasies about love meet reality?
- What things do Sab and Tula have in common despite their differences? What insights does Sab's godmother give them?

• COMPOSITION

Explore how Sab and Tula are reflections of each other's freedom dreams. How are their dreams alike? Different?

WEEK 10 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 10

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What do you remember of Sab's story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.145-159

- Why do you think Tula finally reads her verses in public?
- What do you think will happen after Manuel tells Tula what Mama has planned?

WEEK 11 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 11

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What happened when Tula went to the city to live?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.160-167 & p.175-179

- We are told why Tula is fleeing to Spain. Why do you think Manuel is joining her? Does this contradict Tula's thoughts that men are freer than women?
- What has Tula learned about love during the book?

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 12 30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 12

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Lightning Dreamer

Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8

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Term 2	
WEEK 1	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 13
WEEK 2	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 14
WEEK 3	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 15
WEEK 4	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 16
WEEK 5	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 17
WEEK 6	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 18
WEEK 7	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 19
WEEK 8	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 20
WEEK 9	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 21
WEEK 10	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 22
WEEK 11	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 23
WEEK 12	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 24

Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8

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Term 3	
WEEK 1	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 25
WEEK 2	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 26
WEEK 3	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 27
WEEK 4	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 28
WEEK 5	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 29
WEEK 6	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 30
WEEK 7	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 31
WEEK 8	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 32
WEEK 9	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 33
WEEK 10	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 34
WEEK 11	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 35
WEEK 12	30m Lit./Mythology: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 36

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Examination

Term 1

- Tula defies nearly every expectation placed on her. What does the novel suggest it truly costs to live an authentic life, and is that cost worth it?
- Tula believes that poetry can change the world. By the end of the novel, do you think she has been proven right? Use moments from the story to support your position.

Term 2

- Explain how Scrooge changes from the beginning to the end of A Christmas Carol. What helps him change the most? Use examples from the story.